

Name: _____

Date: _____

Australian Curriculum v9.0 Aligned | AC9E4LY04 | Year 4 | Multisyllabic Words, Figurative Language & Inference

LEARNING INTENTION

I am learning to read a passage using knowledge of multisyllabic words, figurative language and inference skills.

READING STRATEGY

Chunk multisyllabic words into parts. Look for figurative language (similes, metaphors). Use inference — what does the author imply but not directly state?

READ THE PASSAGE — READ IT 3 TIMES!

In 1851, gold was discovered near Bathurst, New South Wales, sparking Australia's first gold rush.

Word spread rapidly and thousands of hopeful prospectors flooded the region.

They came from Britain, China, America and across Australia, seeking their fortune.

Life on the goldfields was gruelling — long days of digging in extreme heat with no guarantee of success.

The influx of people transformed small towns into bustling cities almost overnight.

Tensions rose between European and Chinese miners, leading to violent clashes.

The gold rush shaped Australia's multicultural identity and accelerated its economic growth.

Its legacy can still be seen in the architecture and museums of Ballarat and Bendigo.

VOCABULARY HELPER

prospectors = people who search for gold or minerals

gruelling = extremely tiring and demanding

influx = a large arrival of people or things

multicultural = including people of many different cultures

legacy = something passed down from the past that still has an effect today

WARM UP — BEFORE YOU READ

What do you know about the Australian gold rush? Write one sentence:

A — COMPREHENSION

1. Where was gold first discovered in Australia?

2. Where did prospectors come from?

3. What was life like on the goldfields?

4. Where can the gold rush legacy still be seen today?

B — INFERENCE AND ANALYSIS

1. What does 'flooded the region' tell us about the number of people who came?

2. Why do you think tensions rose between European and Chinese miners?

C — WORD STUDY

Find 2 words with 4+ syllables and break them into parts:

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Accept prior knowledge.

A1. Near Bathurst, New South Wales. **A2.** Britain, China, America and across Australia. **A3.** Gruelling — long days, extreme heat, no guarantee of success. **A4.** In the architecture and museums of Ballarat and Bendigo.

B1. Accept: It was a metaphor for a huge number of people arriving quickly. **B2.** Accept: Competition for land/resources, cultural misunderstanding, unfair treatment.

C 4+ syllables: dis-cov-ered (3), pros-pec-tors (3), mul-ti-cul-tu-ral (5), ac-cel-er-at-ed (5), ar-chi-tec-ture (4) — any 2. **Multicultural:** multi (many) + cultural (relating to culture) = many cultures.

High Five! You are a Super Reader! ✓
Colour a star each time you read the passage aloud:



EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Imagine you are a prospector in 1851. Write a diary entry describing your journey to the goldfields, what you hope to find and how you feel.

PARENT TIP

Visit the gold rush section of a local museum or look up Sovereign Hill in Ballarat online. Ask: 'What part of Australian history interests you most?'

TEACHER TIP

Connect to HASS. Create a gold rush timeline. Students compare life before and after the gold rush using a Venn diagram. Discuss immigration and cultural diversity.

STUDENT REFLECTION

- [] I can use figurative language to understand meaning
- [] I can break multisyllabic words into parts
- [] I can explain how the gold rush shaped Australia